

SAFEGUARDING ADULTS POLICY

Professional Template for CQC-Compliant Healthcare Organisations

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LEGISLATIVE COMPLIANCE:
✓ Care Act 2014 | ✓ Health & Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
✓ Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006 | ✓ Human Rights Act 1998
✓ Equality Act 2010 | ✓ Data Protection Act 2018 | ✓ CQC Fundamental Standards
✓ Mental Capacity Act 2005 | ✓ Serious Crime Act 2015 (Duty to Report)

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APPROVAL & AUTHORISATION

Prepared by:	Barker Scott Ltd	Date:	May 2025
Reviewed by:	CQC Compliance Officer	Date:	May 2025
Authorised by:	Director of Compliance	Date:	May 2025

1. POLICY STATEMENT & PURPOSE

This organisation is unequivocally committed to safeguarding the wellbeing, rights, and dignity of all adults who access our services. We recognise that safeguarding is everyone's responsibility and that all staff, volunteers, contractors, and associated persons have a moral, professional, and legal duty to report concerns about the welfare of adults at risk. This policy sets out how our organisation will identify, prevent, and respond effectively and proportionately to abuse, neglect, exploitation, discrimination, and other forms of harm.

2. SCOPE AND APPLICATION

This policy applies to all staff members, volunteers, contractors, consultants, agency workers, board members, and anyone working on behalf of this organisation who have direct or indirect contact with adults using our services. This includes all locations where services are provided, whether in our premises or in service users' own homes.

3. DEFINITIONS AND KEY CONCEPTS

- **Adult at Risk:** Any person aged 18 years or over who may be in need of community care services by reason of mental or other disability, age or illness; and who is or may be unable to take care of him/herself, or unable to protect him/herself against significant harm or exploitation.
- **Safeguarding:** The process of protecting adults from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and other forms of harm, whilst supporting their right to make informed choices, exercise autonomy, and live independently.
- **Abuse:** A violation of an adult's human and civil rights by another person or persons. May be a single act or repeated pattern of behaviour.
- **Neglect:** The persistent failure to meet an adult's basic physical and/or psychological needs, likely to cause serious impairment of health or development.
- **Exploitation:** The deliberate misuse of power and position to take advantage of an adult for personal gain, financially, sexually, or otherwise.

4. TYPES OF ABUSE AND HARM

- **Physical Abuse:** Assault, hitting, kicking, pushing, inappropriate use of restraint, or other non-consensual physical contact.
- **Emotional/Psychological Abuse:** Threats, insults, humiliation, harassment, controlling behaviour, isolation, or deprivation of meaningful contact.
- **Sexual Abuse:** Non-consensual sexual contact, exploitation, coercion into sexual activity, or exposure to sexual material.
- **Financial Abuse:** Theft, fraud, misappropriation, coercion in relation to financial arrangements, or denial of access to funds.
- **Institutional Abuse:** Systemic abuse arising from the way services are delivered, poor standards, or organisational cultures that condone abuse.
- **Self-Neglect:** Behaviour or inaction which threatens the person's own health or safety.

5. RESPONSIBILITIES AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Board/Senior Leadership

Senior leadership is accountable for ensuring this safeguarding policy and procedures are in place, regularly reviewed, and communicated to all staff. They must allocate appropriate financial and human resources, monitor safeguarding performance, ensure mandatory training compliance, and create a culture where safeguarding concerns are taken seriously.

Designated Safeguarding Lead

The Designated Safeguarding Lead coordinates all safeguarding arrangements, receives and properly assesses concerns, makes timely referrals to local authority social services and other agencies, maintains confidential records, provides advice and guidance to staff, and ensures appropriate follow-up and feedback.

All Staff

All staff must know the signs and symptoms of abuse, maintain professional boundaries, report concerns immediately to the Designated Safeguarding Lead, treat all adults with respect and dignity, maintain confidentiality as appropriate, and comply with this policy and related procedures. Staff have a duty to act and are protected by whistleblowing legislation.

6. IDENTIFYING ABUSE: WARNING SIGNS AND INDICATORS

Staff should be alert to the following signs that may indicate an adult is experiencing abuse or neglect:

- Unexplained injuries, bruises, marks, fractures, or scalds in various stages of healing
- Poor hygiene, malnutrition, untreated medical conditions, or untreated pressure sores
- Withdrawal from usual activities, depression, anxiety, fear, or emotional distress
- Reluctance or refusal to be alone with certain individuals
- Changes in behaviour, mood, or emotional state
- Sexualised behaviour inappropriate to age or development
- Sudden changes in spending patterns or unexplained loss of money or possessions
- Isolation from family, friends, or support networks
- Lack of access to personal hygiene items, medication, or aids to daily living
- Expressions of suicidal ideation or self-harming behaviour

7. SAFEGUARDING PROCEDURES: REPORTING AND REFERRAL

Immediate Response: Any member of staff who suspects abuse must report it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead immediately. This is not optional. If the Safeguarding Lead is implicated in the concern, report to the next senior manager or the board. In cases of immediate danger, contact emergency services (999) and inform the Safeguarding Lead afterwards.

Recording Concerns: All concerns must be recorded in writing as soon as possible. Records should include: name and details of the adult, name and details of the person suspected of causing harm (if known), detailed description of the concern/allegation, when and where the concern arose, any witnesses present, action already taken, and date and time recorded.

Assessment and Referral: The Designated Safeguarding Lead will assess the concern and determine whether to refer to local authority adult social care, the police, or other relevant agencies. A referral should be made if there is reasonable cause to believe that an adult is being or has been abused, neglected, or exploited.

Information Sharing: Information will be shared with other agencies and professionals on a "need to know" basis to protect the adult and prevent harm. This complies with legal requirements and Data Protection legislation. The adult will be kept informed unless doing so would increase risk.

8. CONFIDENTIALITY AND INFORMATION GOVERNANCE

All information relating to safeguarding concerns is treated as confidential and stored securely. Information is only shared with those who have a legitimate professional need to know. The organisation complies fully with the Data Protection Act 2018 and UK GDPR. Staff must not discuss concerns on social media, share identifying information, or breach confidentiality except where required by law or to protect someone from harm.

9. TRAINING AND COMPETENCE

All staff receive mandatory safeguarding training covering: the signs and symptoms of abuse, how to report concerns, this policy and procedures, confidentiality and information sharing, equality and diversity, and mental capacity. Training is provided at induction, annually thereafter, and when policies change. Training records are maintained and monitored by leadership.

10. MONITORING, REVIEW, AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

This policy is reviewed annually and whenever changes to legislation occur. The Safeguarding Lead maintains records of all incidents, concerns, and referrals, and reports regularly to senior management and the board. Trends are analysed to identify learning and drive continuous improvement. External audits may be undertaken.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

This is a professional sample template for preview purposes. The full purchased template includes: detailed procedures, local safeguarding board contact details, incident investigation protocols, staff training materials, and customisation guidance for your specific organisation. For a complete, legally robust policy tailored to your organisation, purchase the full template from Barker Scott Ltd.